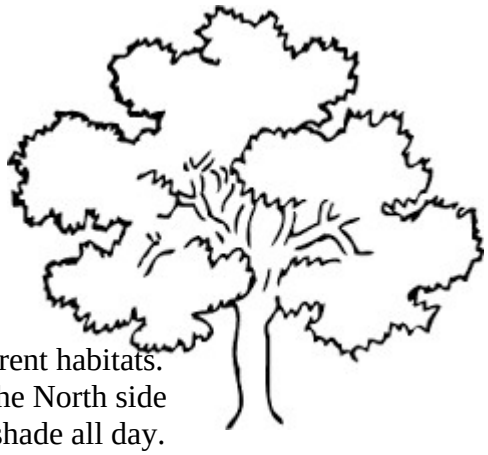
Abiotic Factors and Habitat



Name: _____

Abiotic factors such as temperature and light vary in different habitats, even those quite close to one another.
Look around the school grounds and consider the different habitats. There are garden beds, open grass, shade, habitats on the North side or South side of the school, ponds, those which are in shade all day.
You are to propose an hypothesis about **one** variable in habitats around the school and how it relates to the soil temperature. For example you might hypothesise that soil beneath mulch will be cooler than that without mulch.

Our Hypothesis is:

_____

_____

Give a scientific explanation for your reasoning behind your hypothesis. (why do you think this hypothesis might be correct.

_____

_____

_____

List your independent and dependent variables and at least 4 controlled variables.

_____

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_____

Use a data probe to record soil temperature and use the constant depth of 10cm from the surface.
Decide how many readings you will take.
Draw a table to record your measurements.

1. Was your hypothesis supported by the data? Explain.

_____

_____

_____

2. Do you think your investigation was reliable? Could you have improved its reliability?

_____

_____

_____

3. Comment on the validity of your investigation.

_____

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_____

4. Are there any other abiotic factors which might vary in the habitats you have chosen.

_____

_____

_____

5. Explain how the abiotic factors in the habitats might affect the types of organisms present.

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